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OF SCIENCE AND TECHNOLOGY
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MPU-3283

Small Group Communication

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Managing Conflict in Group: Individual

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Question 1: Scenario

a) What types of conflict are present in this scenario?

In this study group, there are a few different types of conflict happening at the same time.

First, there is a **substantive conflict**. This is a disagreement about the main task. The group members cannot agree on an important part of the project: which software to use for the presentation. Alie wants a complex one, and Andie wants a simple one.

Second, there is a **procedural conflict**. This is about the process or method the group will use. They are arguing about *how* to do the work, which is a conflict over the procedure.

Finally, there seems to be a **personalized or affective conflict**. This conflict is connected to the members' personalities and feelings. For example, Alie is a "perfectionist," and Affie is "frustrated." The problem is not just about the software anymore; it is also about their personal feelings and work styles.

b) Which conflict management strategies (CMS) are Andie and Affie using?

Andie and Affie are using two different strategies to manage the conflict.

Andie is using the **Competing** strategy. She is assertive about her idea to use a simple program because she wants to finish the project quickly. She is focused on her own goal (speed) and is not very cooperative with Alie's idea for a more complex program.

Affie is using the **Avoiding** strategy. She feels uncomfortable with the disagreement and tries to escape it. By changing the topic and hoping the problem disappears, she is not being assertive with her own ideas and is not cooperating to find a solution. She is avoiding the conflict completely.

c) As the facilitator of the group, which CMS would you suggest for the team to use, and why?

As the facilitator, I would suggest the group use the **Collaborating** strategy.

The competing and avoiding strategies are not working and are causing more problems. The collaborating strategy is the best choice here because it is both assertive and cooperative. The project is important and has a tight deadline, so the group needs a solution that everyone can agree on and work with.

I would suggest this strategy because it would make the group talk openly about the problem. They could discuss *why* Alie wants the complex software (maybe for better quality) and *why* Andie wants the simple one (to save time). By understanding each other's needs, they can work together to find a "win-win" solution. For example, maybe Alie can teach the others the basic functions of the complex software, or they could find a different program that is good quality but also easy to use. This way, they can solve the problem together and create a better final project.

Question 2: Simple Answer Needed

What types of conflict are present, and how would you apply the Collaborating conflict management strategy to resolve this situation effectively?

The two types of conflict present are **substantive conflict**, because they disagree about the choice of caterer for the event, and **personalized conflict**, because Alex's choice is based on a personal family connection, not just what is best for the event.

As the leader, I would use the **Collaborating** strategy to solve this problem effectively. Here is how I would apply it:

1. **Start a Discussion:** I would bring Alex and Maya together for a calm and respectful conversation. I would ask both of them to explain their choice of caterer and listen carefully to their reasons.
2. **Identify Shared Goals:** I would remind everyone that our main goal is to have a successful charity event. This means we need good food that people enjoy, but we also need to keep costs low so we can raise more money for charity. This is our common goal.
3. **Brainstorm Solutions:** I would encourage them to think of solutions together. Instead of arguing for one caterer, we could ask, "How can we get the best food at the best price?" For example, we could ask Alex's family member if they can match the price and quality of Maya's option. We could also ask for a food tasting from both caterers so the group can make a fair decision based on quality.
4. **Decide Together:** Finally, based on all the information (price, quality, menu), the group can make a decision that everyone agrees on because it best helps us reach our shared goal. This collaborative approach makes sure everyone feels heard and the final decision is what's best for the charity event.